

Essay Rubric for AP Lit

Thesis Statement				
	4	3	2	1
Thesis	☐ Shows you thought deeply about the question AND text ☐ Answers all parts of the prompt ☐ Clear and easy to understand ☐ Concise	☐ Too long, too much detail OR ☐ Vague, lacking specificity OR ☐ Accurate but poorly phrased	☐ Only answers part of the prompt OR ☐ Is inaccurate due to a misinterpretation	☐ Does not address any part of the prompt ☐ Does not give an argument (merely facts or summary) ☐ Does not make sense

Body Paragraph #1				
	4	3	2	1
Claim	☐ Shows you thought deeply about the question AND text ☐ Answers all parts of the prompt ☐ Clear and easy to understand ☐ Concise	☐ Too long, too much detail OR ☐ Vague, lacking specificity OR ☐ Accurate but poorly phrased	☐ Only answers part of the prompt OR ☐ Is inaccurate due to a misinterpretation	☐ Does not address any part of the prompt ☐ Does not give an argument (merely facts or summary) ☐ Does not make sense
Evidence	☐ You have a direct quote (or, a <i>specific</i> paraphrase if the situation is appropriate) ☐ The direct quote fully supports your claim ☐ Your direct quote has the context needed to understand the quote	☐ No context, or not enough information given to make the context clear OR ☐ Too long, difficult to identify which parts are significant	☐ Paraphrased when a direct quote would be more appropriate OR ☐ Tangential to the claim (related to the claim, but does not directly prove it)	☐ Evidence is entirely unrelated to the claim OR ☐ Evidence is paraphrased poorly , thus too confusing to contribute to the argument

Body Paragraph #1

	4	3	2	1
Reasoning	☐ Identifies the significant aspects of the evidence ☐ Provides in-depth insight into the text & deepens readers' understanding ☐ Explains how the evidence proves the claim	☐ Broad analysis of the text, not a specific analysis of the quote OR ☐ Accurate, but surface-level OR ☐ Accurate but not developed.	☐ Inaccurate OR ☐ Too vague to give insight OR ☐ Accurate but does not relate to claim	☐ Incomprehensible OR ☐ Wholly unrelated to evidence and claim OR ☐ Evidence is summarized
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Synthesis	☐ Connections are made between all points in the paragraph ☐ Arrives at a final conclusion about the text based on synthesis ☐ Shows in-depth insight about text	☐ Connections are present but surface-level OR ☐ Conclusion is present but surface-level	☐ Synthesis or conclusion is missing, inaccurate, or unrelated to paragraph OR ☐ Too vague	☐ All parts are inaccurate OR ☐ Arguments are merely restated or summarized

Body Paragraph #2

	4	3	2	1
Claim	☐ Shows you thought deeply about the question AND text ☐ Answers all parts of the prompt ☐ Clear and easy to understand ☐ Concise	☐ Too long, too much detail OR ☐ Vague, lacking specificity OR ☐ Accurate but poorly phrased	☐ Only answers part of the prompt OR ☐ Is inaccurate due to a misinterpretation	☐ Does not address any part of the prompt ☐ Does not give an argument (merely facts or summary) ☐ Does not make sense
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Conclusion

	4	3	2	1
Conclusion	☐ Connections are made between all paragraphs ☐ Arrives at a final conclusion about the text based on synthesis ☐ Shows in-depth insight about text	☐ Connections are present but surface-level OR ☐ Conclusion is present but surface-level	☐ Synthesis or conclusion is missing, inaccurate, or unrelated to paragraph OR ☐ Too vague	☐ All parts are inaccurate OR ☐ Arguments are merely restated or summarized